

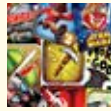
HISTORY OF DARK MATTER



The hunt for a dark matter particle has been on for decades.

Humanity still hasn't produced a clear answer. Is it just in our imaginations or are they real? No definitive answer, but the search has gotten more interesting since the 19th century. <http://dgit.in/Hdarkmatter>

A TAKE ON APPS AND ADS



Get your favourite mobile apps for free and watch annoying ads

in return - This may sound like a fair trade, but the real trade-off isn't really ads for apps - it's intrusive mobile surveillance. Mobile apps collect a massive amount of personal data <http://dgit.in/AppsAds>

CAN AI TURN RACIST?



Algorithmic bias can sometimes turn bots into beasts. Working

on a new product or feature launch? If you're not sure whether algorithmic bias could derail your plan, you should be. Here's a guide on how you can keep your AI from turning into a racist monster. <http://dgit.in/racistAI>

WORLD'S MOST SECRETIVE STARTUP



From magical goggles, to robotic drones, to human-sized robots, the

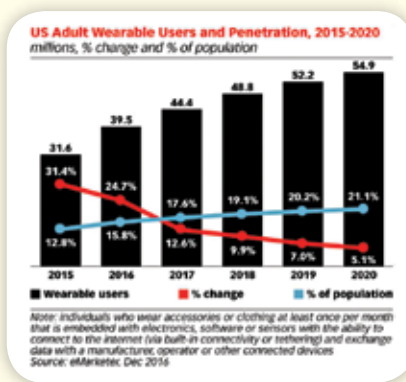
world's hottest startup isn't located in Silicon Valley—it's in suburban Florida. Magic Leap's mind-bending technology tells us about its quest to create a new kind of reality. <http://dgit.in/MagicLeapW>

wearable sellers like Xiaomi and Huawei have adopted in India. GOQii, India's largest wearables vendor by market share, takes a different approach by selling subscriptions instead of devices. The cheapest, 3 month subscription for GOQii services, including a fitness band and real-life health consultations starts at ₹1,999.

Why are they not buying wearables abroad?

In markets that are not driven by price, wearables had a real opportunity to make a difference. However, they have failed to do so. Every now and then Apple launches a watch or Samsung releases a new Gear device, to create some 'buzz' in the market. A market, which for long, has been hoisting red flags for wearable makers. Since 2014, the western world has made its lack of commitment to wearables very apparent. An Endeavour Partners' survey from circa 2014 claimed that 50% of wearables' users had a tendency to dump their devices. As per the report, "The wearables that are very successful are the ones that are designed to solve a very specific problem for someone that a smartphone isn't doing."

Come 2016, a Gartner report remains almost unchanged. According to the findings of the report, the abandonment rate of smartwatches is 29%, and that of fitness trackers is 30%. "The abandonment rate is quite high relative to the usage rate. To offer a compelling enough value proposition, the uses for wearable devices need to be distinct from what smartphones typically provide. Wearables makers need to engage users with incentives and gamification," stated the report.



In this two year period, smartwatches and fitness trackers became smarter, added more sensors, and heightened their appeal. But they still haven't hit the sweet spot with consumers. A study by Strategy Analytics points out that global smartwatch shipments grew by as low as 1% annually, from 8.1 million units in Q4 2015 to 8.2 million in Q4 2016. This, after two consecutive quarters of declining volumes. Another report by eMarketer shows the dire penetration of wearable devices in the US.

"Without a clear use case for smart watches — which have more features than fitness trackers, but significant overlap with smartphone functionality — the more sophisticated, expensive devices have not caught on as quickly as expected," said eMarketer analyst Nicole Perrin in the report.

The Silver Lining

After years of playing the same record, there is one good thing that seems to have come from the wearables space - medical wearables. Why? Because they actually have some utility to offer. In some cases, this could be monitoring long term ill-

nesses, or in others, reminding patients to take their medicines on time, or help a paralysed man feel touch, or even help calm down patients who suffer from panic attacks. Medical wearables have the ability to actually make a difference for their users, as opposed to trackers and smartwatches that bombard people with data they cannot interpret or trust. As per a study carried out by researchers at the University of Pittsburgh, fitness trackers don't actually help people reduce weight and become fitter. Another one published in Lancet Diabetes and Endocrinology, states that while fitness trackers and smartwatches do increase activity levels in people, it is not enough to battle chronic illnesses.

In conclusion, it is safe to say that the days for wearables as we know them now, are numbered. The future belongs to wearables that can do more than just replicate smartphone tasks. Wearables that can truly engage users, assist them



in achieving tasks that they otherwise cannot using a smartphone. Competition for wearables has presented itself in the form of VR/AR headsets, virtual assistants and IoT devices, all of which present stronger use-case scenarios even at their nascent stages.

<http://dgit.in/wearMeNot>